Quick-Start Guide for Applying ADKAR® to Today's Change Challenges

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The adoption challenge:

mobilizing a virtual change agent network

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What are the biggest restraining forces you anticipate?	1. Distracted by current events – focusing solely on the crisis, not the path forward 2. Miscommunication or lack of communication 3. Conflicting or unclear priorities 4. Assumption that executives will effectively cascade the change 5. Not understanding how a virtual change agent network could be helpful 6. Not shifting work to make time and create space	1. Unclear vision or definition of success 2. Lack of sponsorship from senior leaders 3. Not thinking that this is high priority, given current focus on customer triage and response 4. When in crisis mode, people default to what's known and comfortable 5. Members of the network perceive there are few personal benefits for taking on additional responsibilities right now 6. Lack of cohesion and/or slow responsiveness of the network	1. Fear of technology 2. Lack of access to the required technology 3. Personal challenges learning a new way to work 4. Lack of interest in learning new technologies 5. Insufficient time to process and learn how to change 6. Not knowing how to meaningfully engage and influence others virtually 7. Believing that physical separation limits connection 8. Prioritizing current work over the time required to participate in the change network	1. We're running in crisis mode, with no time for people to practice to develop new skills 2. Limited resources and time 3. Fear of the unknown – most people have never been asked to do this before 4. Lack of access to stakeholder groups in some locations 5. No one to engage – staff have been furloughed 6. Technology limitations 7. Physical separation and lack of connection	1. Believing that this crisis is a one-time thing that will be over soon, so why bother doing anything innovative 2. Recognition and other rewards don't feel as authentic when presented virtually 3. Loss of rapport amongst members of the network 4. New mindset/attitudes/ beliefs not established 5. Not taking time for a retrospective
How might we overcome these restraining forces?	1. Have leadership reach out, supported by aligned actions from middle managers 2. Create opportunities out of the crisis 3. Build a vision of the "new normal" 4. Help people overcome fear with facts 5. Show how a network can help to alleviate miscommunications 6. Engage employees in solving the problems or addressing the opportunities facing the organization 7. Demonstrate effective online behaviors for others to follow	1. Have senior leaders share a vision of how the crisis is an opportunity for their organizations to pivot 2. Don't let a disaster go to waste. Use this time to create better ways to change and change quickly 3. Focus the efforts of the network on addressing meaningful problems/ opportunities 4. Identify short-term wins and clearly define what success looks like 5. Provide clear guidelines 6. Invest in shared experience 7. Acknowledge the intrinsic value in helping others	1. Crowdsource the solution. Ask others! 2. Make sure everyone knows who the members of the change agent network are 3. Be patient. It's not just about developing quick solutions, quality is also important 4. Demonstrate empathy and understanding with people who struggle with technology 5. Provide additional support for those who have a barrier point at Knowledge 6. Think big, start small	1. Leaders need to acknowledge the challenges of the situation 2. Leaders also need to lead by example – demonstrate that they are using the technology too 3. Provide opportunities to practice in safe environments 4. Be encouraging to those exhibiting fear to this new virtual setting 5. Provide variety in the use of virtual approaches. Don't just use Zoom. Consider using discussion boards, small groups, read backs, etc. 6. Share best practices 7. Remember we all put our pants on one leg at a time	1. Ensure executives are reinforcing desired behaviors and celebrating successes virtually 2. Share lessons learned as a virtual team 3. Focus on sharing successes in team meetings 4. Create and share online thank-you cards 5. Offer 'duvet days' as a reward – stay in your bed 6. Send a 'happy gram' video 7. Use gamification to support Reinforcement

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